

Weekly Updates: Caveats and Considerations for Engineers

Also known as Weekly Updates, Highlights, 3Ps, and other names it has been called over the past six months.

This guide covers what changed with multiple epic linking, how your reports reach TEA Central, and the lessons we learned so your updates land correctly every week.

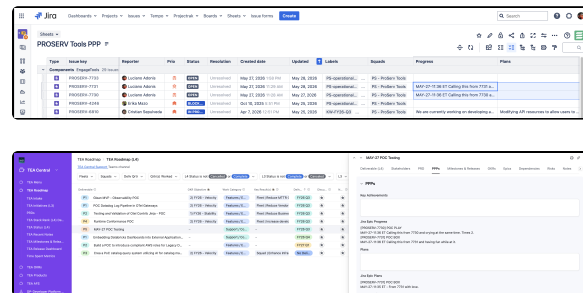
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New Feature: Multiple Epic Linking

A single deliverable can now link to more than one Jira epic. From your side, the way you write updates does not change. You still fill in **Progress, Plans, and Problems** on each epic in Jira exactly as before.

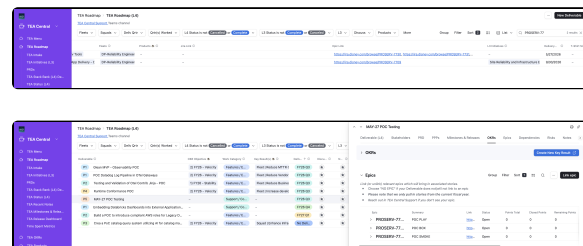
The only new expectation is that you report on every epic you own. A few things to keep in mind:

- If two epics roll up to the same deliverable, both need their own update.
- There is no need to merge them or write a combined summary.
- As long as each epic is linked correctly to the deliverable, your text reaches TEA Central on its own and appears alongside the other epics.
- Each epic shows up in its own block, prefixed with its key such as **[PROSERV-7730]** and the epic summary.
- Your work stays clearly attributed and is never blended into someone else's update.



You can confirm that your epic is linked by checking the deliverable Epics section from the [TEA Central Roadmap \(L4\) page](#).

- If you don't know the name of your deliverable, you can search it by using the epic number.
- If your epic is not listed there or is not tied to the right deliverable, your update will not roll up. In that case, work with your Project Manager to fix the link before the next sync.



Lessons Learned and Best Practices

These habits came directly from testing and will save you from confusing results:

- **Append within the same week instead of overwriting.** When you have more to add later in the week, add to the existing entry under the correct Tuesday date rather than clearing the cell and starting over. Treat the field like a running log for the week, not a one shot form.
- **Clearing a field really does clear it.** If you delete the text in Progress, Plans, or Problems, the rollup will show that field as blank. It does not fall back to the previous week's text, so only clear a field when you intend it to be empty.
- **Updating one epic affects only that epic.** When you change a single epic, just that epic's block updates in the deliverable. The other epics linked to the same deliverable stay exactly as they were.
- **A Problems only update behaves the same way.** If you add a Problem and touch nothing else, only the Problems block changes, and your Progress and Plans remain intact.

What to Assume and What Not to Assume

You can assume that:

- A correctly linked epic will reach the deliverable on the next sync.
- Each epic stays clearly labeled with its own key and summary.
- The most recent saved text in each field is what gets recorded.

Do not assume that:

- The sync happens instantly or in the morning.
- Mid day edits replace what already synced on the same day.
- An emptied field will keep its old contents.

When in doubt, save your final text before noon Eastern and verify the epic link in Airtable.

How Your Update Reaches TEA Central

Your update travels from Jira into TEA Central through the integration during a scheduled sync. A few points are worth keeping in mind so the timing works in your favor:

- The sync runs around **noon Eastern**, so plan to have your update saved in Jira before then. An earlier run was discussed in the past, but in practice you should not count on anything before roughly 12 PM ET.
- The sync captures whatever your fields contain at the moment it runs. It reads the current text rather than replaying every change you made during the day, so if you save once and leave it, that is what gets picked up.
- If you edit the same field more than once before a single sync, only the final text is captured. Earlier versions from that same morning are not kept as separate entries.
- If you make a change after the sync has already run, it will not appear until the following day's sync.

A Typical Week, Start to Finish

Here is what a normal week looks like from your side:

- **Throughout the week:** Do the work and jot down quick notes on what you finished, what is next, and anything blocking you.
- **Monday:** Write your update in Jira for each epic you own. This is the ideal time, since it gives you a full day of buffer before the sync.
- **Tuesday before noon ET:** If you did not get to it on Monday, you still have until the sync runs. Save your final text in Jira and use the Tuesday date for the week.
- **Tuesday around noon ET:** The sync runs and your text flows into TEA Central, joined with any other epics on the same deliverable.

- **After the sync:** Anything you add later in the week should be appended under the same Tuesday date, and it will be picked up on the next day's sync.
- **As a last resort:** If you are unable to submit at all, your Project Manager can enter the update for you in PPP Promoter. Treat this as a backup rather than the normal path, and give them your text and the correct Tuesday date.

If You Cannot Submit Through Jira

This process relies on the TEA Central Integration and requires Golden Standards to be set up in your project with Jira Sync enabled. If either step is missing, work with your Project Manager to add it to the project. If you are unable to submit updates through Jira at all, use the Weekly Updates Form instead.